

4 Geese in the park

The setting for this painting is a hot summer's day with brilliant back lighting. To help create this effect, the whites and palest tones are preserved by slowly building up layers of color around them. A limited palette is used, with yellow as the dominant color. While this is mixed with other colors in the yellow-green background, the yellow and orange of the chicks are carefully layered, to keep them clean and bright. The muted blues and violets used to define the geese help to emphasize the bright, warm colors used in the rest of the painting.

EQUIPMENT

- Cold-pressed paper
- Brushes: No. 5, No. 9, 1 in (25 mm) flat
- Cadmium yellow, cerulean blue, Windsor violet, cadmium orange, burnt sienna, cadmium red, emerald green, French ultramarine, burnt umber, alizarin crimson

TECHNIQUES

- Layering
- Wet-in-wet

TRYING OUT COLORS



A color test sheet is a good way to plan which colors to use. Trying out strokes and blocks of different colors will give you a good idea of what they will look like when they are mixed together wet-in-wet on the paper rather than on your palette.

“Layering keeps colors pure and vibrant.”



- 1 Paint the chicks and the geese's bodies and heads cadmium yellow, using the No. 9 brush. Then paint the geese's heads and necks cerulean blue and their chests Windsor violet.

BUILDING THE IMAGE

